

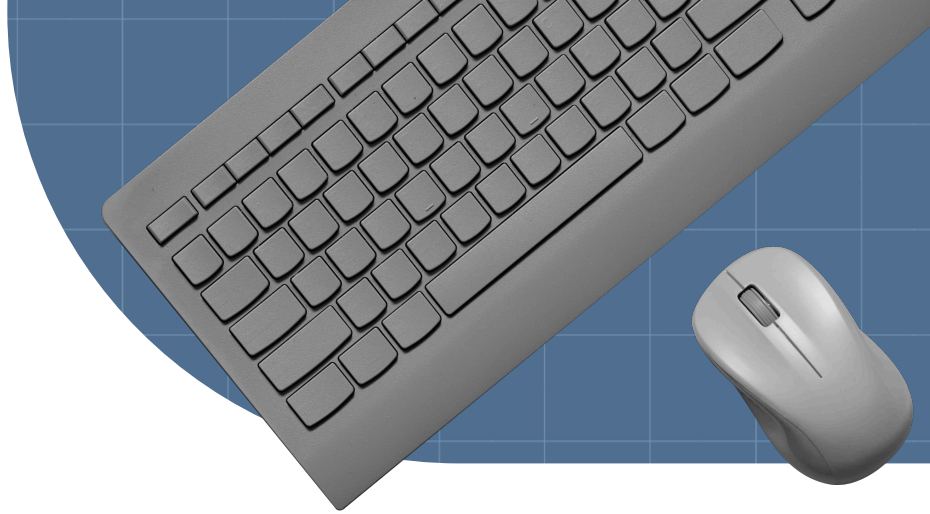
HOW TO DO 10 HOURS OF RESEARCH IN 20 MINUTES:

The Marketer's Guide to Google Gemini & NotebookLM



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The Challenge of Traditional Research

Traditional research sucks up your time. It's the black hole of marketing productivity where hours disappear with minimal return.

When you're manually searching for information, you're crippling your efficiency.

“

As Kieran Flanagan puts it: “What I would have done before this is I would have gone and done a bunch of manual research and kind of called it and copied it together... I probably only would have gone to like 10 or 15 of those 32 websites. I wouldn't have found all 32.”



Let's be honest about traditional research:

- You're settling for incomplete information
- You're wasting hours that could drive revenue
- You're missing insights your competitors might catch
- You're falling behind while trying to keep up

For marketers who need to become experts on new topics quickly, the old way is a competitive liability, not just an inconvenience.

Why AI is a game changer for marketers

AI research tools aren't just better—they're in a different league altogether. They transform the knowledge game completely.

“



Kieran nails it: “We’re talking about how you go from knowing very, very little about something to being a top 20% expert in knowledge in a topic in days or weeks, not months or years.”

Here's the unfair advantage AI research gives you:



10x time compression

What took days now takes minutes—full stop



Superhuman coverage

AI processes more sources than your entire team could handle



Connect-the-dots brilliance

AI spots patterns across sources that humans simply miss



Democratized expertise

Anyone on your team can develop subject matter expertise rapidly

“

The result? As Kieran puts it, it's “transformational in terms of your ability to find, access and process information.”

Marketers not embracing AI research are already falling behind—and the gap is widening every day. The competitive edge isn't coming next year. It's here now.

Ready to create an unfair advantage for yourself? Let's dig into how these tools actually work.



How Google Gemini Deep Research Works

Automating research with AI

Google Gemini's Deep Research doesn't just assist your research—it revolutionizes it. This isn't an incremental improvement; it's a complete paradigm shift.

“



Kieran doesn't mince words about its impact: “I'm a very curious person. I want to get into the details of a topic and deep research has been an amazing way to do that.”

Here's the simple yet powerful process:

- 1 You ask a detailed question
- 2 Gemini does the hard work by crawling dozens of sources
- 3 It synthesizes everything into a comprehensive report
- 4 You get expert-level insights in minutes, not days





Quick Steps for Automating Research with Google Gemini:

- 1 Go to Google Gemini (gemini.google.com)
- 2 Sign in with your Google account
- 3 Click on "Deep Research" in the options
- 4 Enter a detailed research query
(be specific about what you want to learn)
- 5 Wait as Gemini searches multiple sources
(usually 3-5 minutes)
- 6 Review the generated report with all citations included

While other marketers are still gathering information, you're already implementing insights and moving on to your next challenge.

Synthesizing large amounts of information quickly

Here's why this is a game-changer: Gemini doesn't just find information faster—it processes information at a scale no human could match.

“



Kieran highlights what makes this so powerful: “What you'll see right now is that Gemini is working and it has researched over 32 websites on this topic. You can see all of them there, has everything attributed and now it's in the midst of creating my report.”

The screenshot displays the Gemini Advanced interface. On the left, a sidebar shows a 'Start research' button and a chat window titled 'AI in Marketing Research Trends' with the status 'Researching 8 websites...'. The main panel, titled 'AI in Marketing Research Trends', shows 'Researching 8 websites...' and a list of sources being researched. The sources include:

- AI and marketing research: Treating AI as an assistant, n... (quirks.com/articles/ai-and-marketing-research-treating-...)
- AI's impact on market research: What to expect in 2025 ... (quirks.com/articles/ai-s-impact-on-market-research-wha...)
- AI in Marketing: Research Study, Stats, Industry Trends ... (foundationinc.co/lab/ai-marketing-results)
- The Future of Market Research: How AI and Machine Le... (researchworld.com/articles/the-future-of-market-resear...)
- A Strategic Approach to AI in Market Research - Remesh (remesh.ai/resources/the-evolution-of-ai-in-market-resear...)
- AI to Drive Massive Changes to Market Research in 202... (qualtrics.com/news/ai-to-drive-massive-changes-to-mar...)
- The state of AI in early 2024: Gen AI adoption spikes an... (mckinsey.com/capabilities/quantumblack/our-insights/the...)
- Artificial Intelligence Market Size | Industry Report, 203... (grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/artificial-intelli...)

The competitive advantages are clear:

- You access more sources than your competition even knows exist
- You get consistent analysis across all materials
- You receive organized insights ready for immediate use
- You maintain credibility with proper attribution



Quick Steps for Synthesizing Information with Google Gemini:

- 1 Examine the list of sources Gemini has processed
- 2 Review the structured report with main sections and subsections
- 3 Click "Open in Google Docs" to save the report for further use or sharing
- 4 Verify key information by checking the original sources if needed

“



The time savings are nothing short of revolutionary. Kieran puts it bluntly: “That took about five minutes. Before, that would have taken me five hours.”

That's not just efficiency—it's a direct competitive advantage over marketers stuck in the old research paradigm.

Example: Conducting AI agent research in minutes

Want to see this in action? Here's how Kieran leveraged Gemini to become an instant expert on AI agents and their marketing applications.

“



His request was direct, specific, and succinct: “I want you to do a deep research project for me on artificial intelligence agents. I want to know what they're capable of automating well today, what they're not capable of automating well today, when should I use an agent versus a traditional web application? And how should I think about how AI agents should be used in marketing?”

I want you to do a deep research project for me on artificial intelligence agents. I want to know what they're capable of automating well today, what they're not...

✦ Here's my plan to tackle that topic. Let me know if you need to make changes.

AI Agents Deep Research Project

Research Websites

I want you to do a Deep Research project for me on artificial intelligence agents. I want to know what they're capable of automating well today, what they're not capable of automating well today, when should I use an agent versus a traditional web application? And how should I think about how AI agents should be used in marketing?

(1) Find research papers and articles on the capabilities of AI agents today.

(2) Find case studies of successful and unsuccessful AI agent implementations....

[More](#)

Analyze Results

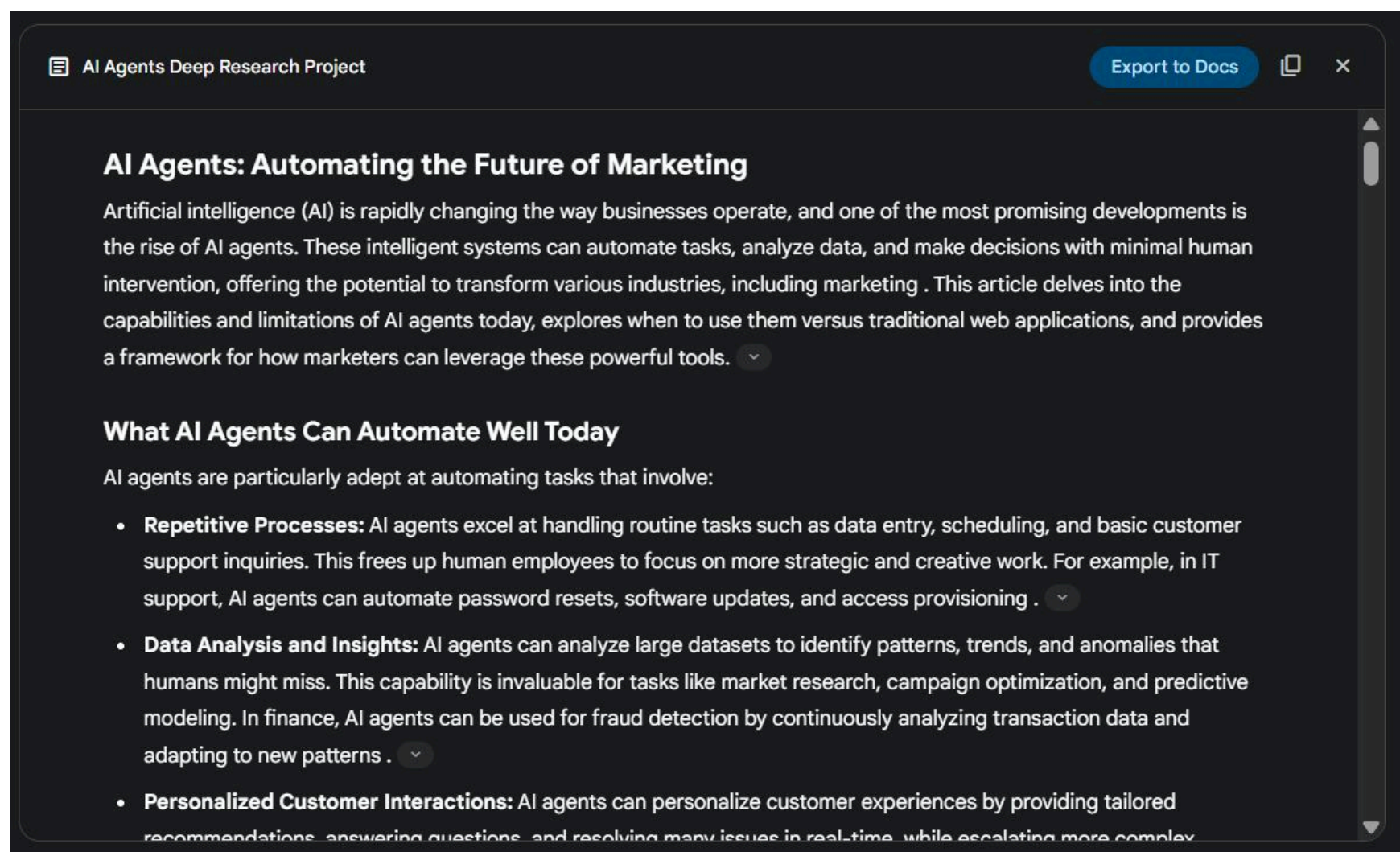
Create Report

Ready in a few mins

Edit plan

Start research

Within minutes, Gemini delivered a detailed report that would have taken hours—if not days—to compile manually.



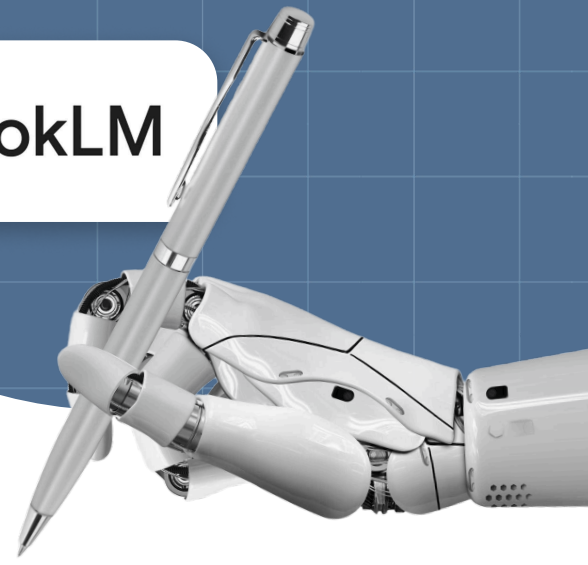
This isn't just saving time—it's redefining what's possible for marketers who need to quickly develop expertise across multiple domains. While your competitors are still figuring out the basics, you're already implementing advanced strategies.



Want to Stay Ahead of AI Trends in Marketing? Subscribe to Marketing Against the Grain

Don't stop your AI learning journey here. Join Kipp Bodnar (HubSpot's CMO) and Kieran Flanagan (HubSpot's SVP of Marketing) on Marketing Against the Grain for fresh perspectives on AI tools and innovative marketing strategies you won't find anywhere else. Subscribe on YouTube to get notified about new episodes that will help you apply AI tools like a pro.

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Using NotebookLM for AI-Driven Knowledge Management

Organizing research in a digital notebook

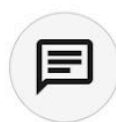
Gemini gets you the raw materials, but NotebookLM turns information into actionable intelligence. This isn't just a note-taking app—it's a knowledge command center.

Create your first notebook

NotebookLM is an AI-powered research and writing assistant that works best with the sources you upload



Upload your documents and NotebookLM will answer detailed questions or surface key insights



Convert complex material into easy-to-understand formats like FAQs or Briefing Docs



Add key resources to a notebook and share with your org to create a group knowledge base

Create

“



Kieran explains the core purpose: “The goal of this tool is to let you create a notebook of lots of materials that you're trying to learn about or work with.”

What makes NotebookLM a marketer's secret weapon is its flexibility. Your notebook becomes a centralized hub for:

- Gemini research reports
- YouTube videos and podcasts
- Web articles and blog posts
- PDFs and other documents
- Email newsletters



Quick Steps for Creating a Digital Notebook:

- 1 Go to notebooklm.google.com
- 2 Click "Create a new notebook"
- 3 Name your notebook based on your research topic
- 4 Click "Add Sources" to begin importing content
- 5 Import your Gemini research by selecting "Google Docs"
- 6 Add additional sources (articles, videos, etc.) via URL or direct upload
- 7 Organize sources with labels if needed

While other marketers struggle with disconnected research files scattered across their drives, you'll have a single, unified knowledge base ready for action.

Creating interactive, AI-powered summaries

Here's where most marketers miss the point: NotebookLM isn't just storage—it's an active intelligence partner that extracts exactly what you need to know.

“



Kieran shows how a simple prompt unleashes this power: “I would like a detailed summary from all sources that outlines the five best uses of AI agents today. Five examples of how to use them in your marketing and an executive summary.”



Quick Steps for Creating AI-Powered Summaries:

- 1 Add all your research sources to NotebookLM (reports, articles, videos, etc.)
- 2 Click on the prompt field at the bottom of your notebook
- 3 Enter a specific request (e.g., "Create a summary of the key points about AI agents in marketing")
- 4 Be specific about the format you want (bullet points, executive summary, etc.)
- 5 Review the generated summary, which will include citations to your source materials

The system responds with insights pulled from across all sources, complete with citations. This capability lets you:

- Extract critical insights in seconds, not hours
- Focus on applying knowledge rather than organizing it
- Create ready-to-share deliverables for stakeholders
- Generate new content based on solid research

While your competitors are still reading through their research, you're already implementing the key insights.

Audio overviews and interactive Q&A

This feature isn't just cool—it's a productivity multiplier that turns dead time into learning time. NotebookLM transforms your research into an interactive podcast you can engage with anywhere.

“



“This is like having a personal podcast,” Kieran explains. The system creates audio summaries of your research that you can consume on the go.



Quick Steps for Audio Overviews:

- 1 After adding sources to your notebook, locate the "Generate Audio Overview" option
- 2 Click to generate the overview (processing takes a few minutes)
- 3 Once ready, press play to listen to your personalized research podcast
- 4 The overview will synthesize information from all your sources

Even more revolutionary is the interactive Q&A feature. You don't just listen—you participate.

“



When Kieran asks, “I was hoping that you could explain to me how I should be using AI agents in my marketing strategy based on what you two know,” the system responds with relevant insights drawn directly from his sources.



Quick Steps for Interactive Q&As:

- 1 While listening to the audio overview, click the "Join Conversation" button
- 2 Ask your question when prompted (e.g., "How can I apply this to my email marketing?")
- 3 The AI hosts will respond with relevant information from your sources
- 4 Continue the conversation with follow-up questions as needed

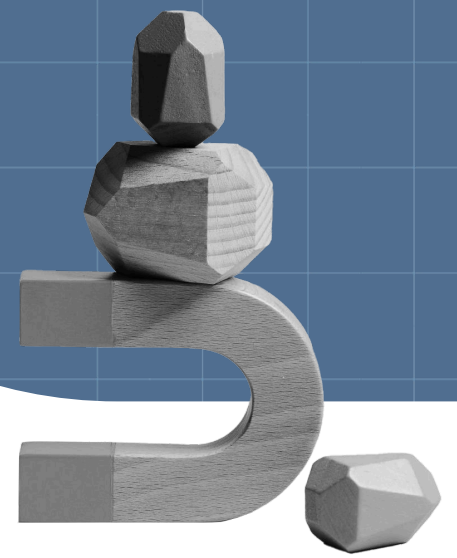
“



Kipp highlights the practical business impact: “You can take all those documents, have NotebookLM generate a personal podcast for you, right? A podcast that is just for you, that you can then listen to on your walk, on your commute, wherever it may be, and be fully prepped.”

This means turning your commute, workout, or lunch break into productive learning time—another edge over marketers stuck in traditional research methods.

How to Stack AI Tools for a Complete Research Workflow



Step-by-step guide to using Gemini and NotebookLM together

Using these tools separately is powerful. Stacking them creates a research superpower that most marketers don't even know exists.

“



Kieran doesn't hold back on his assessment: “I think Google has built the best stack of products for research on the planet. Like, if you are trying to do great research, I think the combination of Google Gemini 1.5 with deep research and NotebookLM is unmatched for the ability to get a lot of information in one place.”



Quick Steps for the Complete Workflow:

- 1 Start with Gemini Deep Research to gather comprehensive information
- 2 Export your Gemini research report to Google Docs
- 3 Open NotebookLM and create a new notebook for your topic
- 4 Import your Gemini research as your first source



- 5 Add complementary sources (articles, videos, newsletters)
- 6 Use NotebookLM to generate summaries across all sources
- 7 Create an audio overview for on-the-go learning
- 8 Use interactive Q&A to explore specific aspects of your research

This isn't just a better research system—it's a complete knowledge acceleration platform that compounds your marketing intelligence advantage.

11 practical applications for content creation, marketing strategy, and more

These aren't just cool tools—they're business accelerators that directly impact your marketing performance. Here's how the Gemini + NotebookLM stack transforms key marketing functions:

Content Creation Workflow:

- 1 Use Gemini to research a topic thoroughly (industry trends, competitor approaches)
- 2 Export research to NotebookLM and add examples, case studies, and relevant media
- 3 Generate a content outline based on the consolidated research
- 4 Create audio summaries to share key points with your content team
- 5 Use the interactive Q&A to explore creative angles and examples

Marketing Strategy Development:

- 1 Research market trends and competitive landscape with Gemini
- 2 Add customer feedback, sales data, and industry reports to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate summaries that identify strategic opportunities
- 4 Share audio overviews with stakeholders for alignment
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to test strategic assumptions

Customer Research:

- 1 Use Gemini to research target audience behaviors and preferences
- 2 Import customer feedback, surveys, and support tickets into NotebookLM
- 3 Generate audience personas based on all sources
- 4 Create audio summaries of customer insights for your team
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to explore specific customer segments

“



Kipp highlights the power of this approach for customer research: “You can create basically a custom podcast of your customer NP's and in ten minutes get the best summary ever of what your customers do and don't like about your product.”

Industry Analysis for New Markets:

- 1 Use Gemini to research industry trends, market size, and key players in a new sector
- 2 Import analyst reports, news articles, and competitor websites into NotebookLM
- 3 Generate a comprehensive market overview with growth projections
- 4 Create an audio summary for executives considering market entry
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to explore regulatory challenges or regional differences

Competitive Intelligence Program:

- 1 Research competitors' product offerings, pricing, and positioning with Gemini
- 2 Add earnings calls transcripts, customer reviews, and marketing materials to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate a competitive matrix highlighting strengths and weaknesses
- 4 Create regular audio briefings on competitor movements for your sales team
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to explore how competitors address specific customer pain points

Campaign Planning and Development:

- 1 Research successful campaigns in your industry using Gemini
- 2 Import performance data from past campaigns, audience insights, and creative examples to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate a summary of effective messaging approaches and channel strategies
- 4 Create audio overviews of campaign concepts for creative team alignment
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to explore potential campaign risks or messaging refinements

Product Marketing Preparation:

- 1 Use Gemini to research customer needs, competitor products, and market gaps
- 2 Add product specs, engineering documentation, and beta user feedback to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate positioning documents that align features with market needs
- 4 Create audio summaries of value propositions for sales enablement
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to address common objections or technical questions

Social Media Content Strategy:

- 1 Research trending topics and content performance patterns with Gemini
- 2 Import engagement metrics, audience demographics, and high-performing content examples to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate a content calendar with theme recommendations and format suggestions
- 4 Create audio briefings for social media creators
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to brainstorm content ideas for specific platforms or campaigns

Events and Webinar Planning:

- 1 Research industry events, speakers, and popular session topics using Gemini
- 2 Add attendee feedback, session recordings, and presentation materials from past events to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate recommendations for formats, topics, and speaker selection
- 4 Create audio briefings for event planning teams
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to explore logistics questions or programming alternatives

SEO Content Optimization:

- 1 Use Gemini to research keyword opportunities, search intent, and top-ranking content
- 2 Import analytics data, search console reports, and competitor content into NotebookLM
- 3 Generate content briefs organized by search intent and keyword clusters
- 4 Create audio summaries explaining SEO strategy to content creators
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to explore specific ranking factors or content structure recommendations

Crisis Communication Planning:

- 1 Research similar crisis situations in your industry using Gemini
- 2 Add crisis response examples, media coverage, and stakeholder feedback to NotebookLM
- 3 Generate response templates and communication workflows for different scenarios
- 4 Create audio briefings for leadership on crisis readiness
- 5 Use interactive Q&A to practice responses to potential media questions

Real-World AI Use Cases for Marketers



Personalizing marketing and customer engagement

Let's get real: Personalization without AI is just guesswork. With tools like Gemini and NotebookLM, it becomes precision marketing.

“



The number one AI application in marketing? As Kieran puts it: “Personalizing your marketing, customer engagement. That's the number one use case we have seen in doing our work at HubSpot with AI.”



Quick Steps for Personalization:

- 1 Use Gemini to research customer segments and personalization strategies
- 2 Import customer data, engagement metrics, and feedback into NotebookLM
- 3 Generate personalized messaging frameworks for different segments
- 4 Test personalization approaches with interactive Q&A
- 5 Implement insights into your marketing automation platform

Marketers who aren't leveraging AI for personalization aren't just missing opportunities—they're actively falling behind competitors who can understand and address customer needs with greater precision.

Automating social media and email marketing

AI isn't just enhancing marketing—it's eliminating the tedious tasks that drain your team's creative energy.



Quick Steps for Marketing Automation:

- 1 Research best practices for automation using Gemini
- 2 Import performance data and current workflows into NotebookLM
- 3 Identify automation opportunities within your existing processes
- 4 Create structured templates and decision trees for AI assistance
- 5 Gradually implement automation while monitoring performance

Smart marketers aren't asking if they should automate—they're asking what they should automate next to free up more strategic thinking time.

AI-driven content creation and campaign management

Content creation without AI assistance is the marketing equivalent of using a typewriter in the digital age—functional but wildly inefficient.

“



Kipp Bodnar cuts to the heart of the matter: “We're going to use AI and engineering to automate a lot of the manual work that, quite frankly, no human likes to do. Nobody likes writing podcast descriptions, right? What a human likes doing is coming up with what's the topic for the podcast? What are people really going to like about it, honing? That intro to get people hooked right off the bat, right? That's where a human wants to spend their time.”



Quick Steps for AI-Driven Content Creation:

- 1 Use Gemini to research topics and gather comprehensive information
- 2 Import brand guidelines, past content, and performance metrics into NotebookLM
- 3 Generate content outlines and drafts based on your research
- 4 Review and enhance AI-generated content with your unique perspective
- 5 Create audio summaries to brief stakeholders on content strategy

“

For campaign management, AI agents don't just assist—they transform the process by “managing an entire social media campaign... generating content, then scheduling posts, and even analyzing engagement.”

The key insight is clear: AI doesn't replace human creativity—it amplifies it by handling the grunt work. This isn't about eliminating marketing jobs; it's about eliminating marketing busywork.

“



As Kipp explains: “NotebookLM for research focused purposes, especially for customer research or storytelling research is a really great tool to help you bring everything together, get a deep understanding, and then output summaries and audio or text to really get a condensed understanding of what's going on.”

Marketers who embrace these AI tools aren't just working smarter—they're playing an entirely different game than their competitors.